

# NVIDIA NIM API Key Setup

Get your build.nvidia.com API key for the NVIDIA Ising Calibration model

Prerequisite · One-time setup · Do this before you start

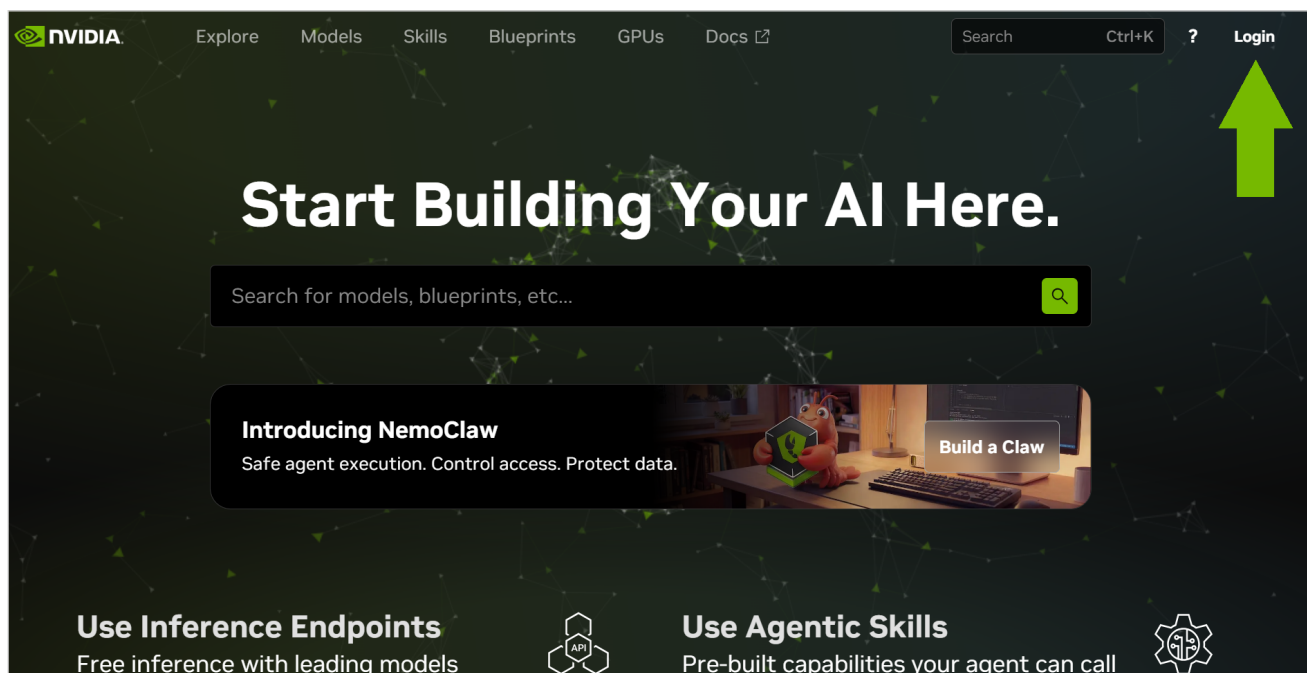
**You need one free NVIDIA API key.** Generate it once at build.nvidia.com, copy the value that starts with nvapi-, and keep it somewhere you can paste from. The same key works for every model in the NVIDIA API catalog, so this is a one-time action.

## Before you begin

- A web browser and an email address you can receive mail on.
- An NVIDIA account. You can create one during login, and it is free.
- Free API access is rate limited to **40 requests per minute (RPM)**, which is ample for working through the material one request at a time.

## Step 1 | Sign in at build.nvidia.com

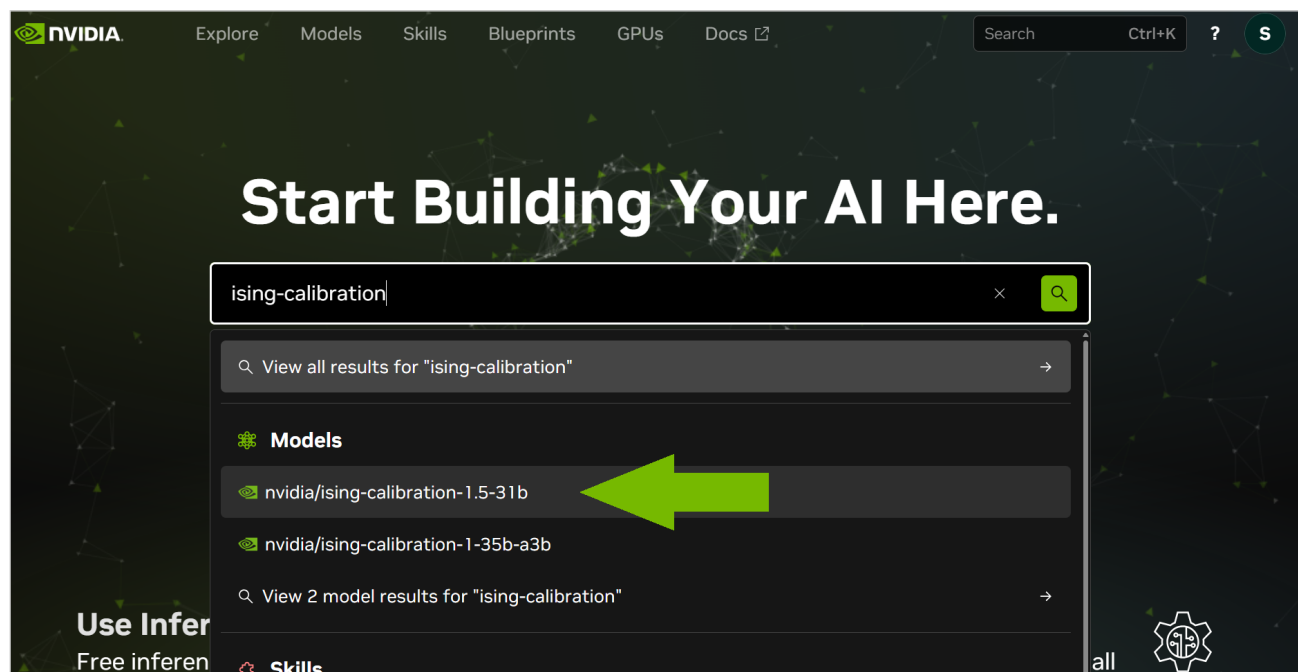
Open <https://build.nvidia.com/> and click **Login** at the top right of the navigation bar. Sign in with your NVIDIA account, or create one on the spot. Once you are signed in, the Login button is replaced by your account avatar.



The build.nvidia.com home page. **Login** sits at the far right of the top navigation bar.

## Step 2 | Open the Ising Calibration model

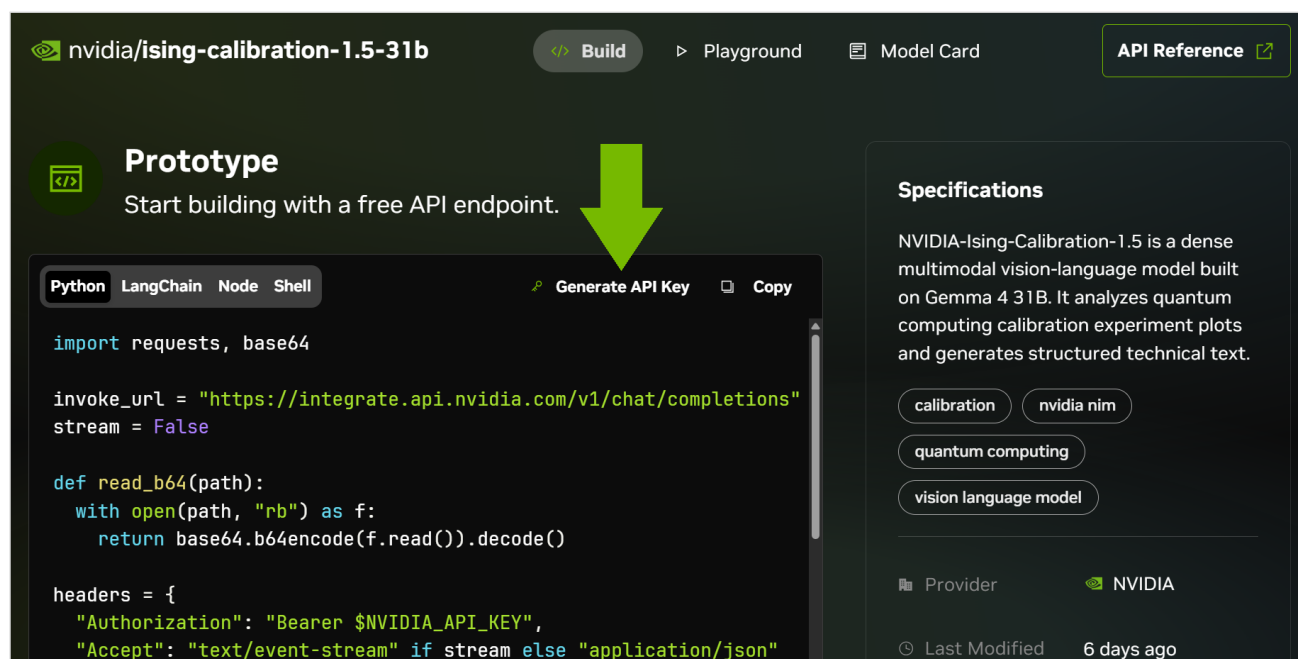
Type `ising-calibration` into the search box. Under **Models**, two similarly named entries appear — choose `nvidia/ising-calibration-1.5-31b`. You can also go straight to <https://build.nvidia.com/nvidia/ising-calibration-1.5-31b>



Search results for "ising-calibration". Pick the **1.5-31b** entry, not the other one.

## Step 3 | Click Generate API Key

On the model page, stay on the **Build** tab. The dark code panel shows a ready-made request, with tabs for Python, LangChain, Node and Shell. **Generate API Key** sits in the panel header, next to **Copy** — click it.



The **Build** tab of the model page. **Generate API Key** is in the header of the code panel.



## Key facts

| Item                 | Value                                                                                                                             |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Portal               | <a href="https://build.nvidia.com/">https://build.nvidia.com/</a>                                                                 |
| Model page           | <a href="https://build.nvidia.com/nvidia/ising-calibration-1.5-31b">https://build.nvidia.com/nvidia/ising-calibration-1.5-31b</a> |
| Model ID             | nvidia/ising-calibration-1.5-31b                                                                                                  |
| Endpoint             | <a href="https://integrate.api.nvidia.com/v1">https://integrate.api.nvidia.com/v1</a>                                             |
| Chat path            | /v1/chat/completions                                                                                                              |
| Environment variable | NVIDIA_API_KEY                                                                                                                    |
| Key prefix           | nvapi-                                                                                                                            |
| Auth header          | Authorization: Bearer <your key>                                                                                                  |

## Good to know

- **One key, whole catalog.** The same key authenticates every model in the NVIDIA API catalog, so you only do this once.
- **Treat it like a password.** Do not commit it, paste it into shared documents, or leave it visible in screenshots.
- **Lost the value?** It is shown only once. Go back to the model page and click **Generate API Key** again.

## Takeaway

Sign in, open the model page, click **Generate API Key**, and copy the `nvapi-` string. That is the whole prerequisite.

## References

- NVIDIA API catalog – <https://build.nvidia.com/>
- NVIDIA Ising Calibration 1.5 (31B) model page – <https://build.nvidia.com/nvidia/ising-calibration-1.5-31b>
- NVIDIA LLM API endpoint – <https://integrate.api.nvidia.com/v1>